

Student Advising-

Three major areas for advising: General, Practicum and Problem solving/Advocacy

General: First semester general support of being a new student, sometimes this involves some class flow questions, what instructors to take and how to deal with the stress of being a new student (study hacks). Other questions are around LMFT vs. LPCC (can refer to Collin or Mohi). Every semester you should send out an email or newsletter (whatever you have the band with for) to do some proactive contact, remind them of important dates (like add/drop) and give them your office hours/ best times to contact you. It is important to try to check in with all advisees once a semester. In reality this at times can be hard to do if you have a large advisee load. Limit meeting times to 15 minutes. Do not take on students to your advisee load if you are at 40 students.

Practicum: Pre practicum convos: around therapy styles and possible clinic site placement. Practicum readiness (go over flow chart) have they done all their pre-prac classes? You must check their unofficial transcript (in colleague) to make sure they have passed all their pre-prac classes and have no incompletes (I/IP) or any failed classes that they have not retaken. They must meet with you to go over the application you cannot just sign it. The flow chart can also serve as a cheat sheet to make sure they have all the requirements accomplished. As part of the review you should review their clinical evals before you meet with them to identify themes and what students are doing to work on negative themes. You need this in particular for the Faculty readiness review meetings. In the meeting where you go over their practicum application it is a good idea to have a discussion about if their ready for practicum and their fears and or anxieties about starting practicum.

Problem Solving/Advocacy: Complaints and ruptures, with instructors, with students, with an entire class or cohort. (see rupture and repair handout). I first try to advocate to see if they have talked to the instructor to work out the problem. You might have to facilitate a convo with them and the instructor. If is a Title 9 situation you must notify the chairs immediately. Sometimes we need to advocate for advisees for various other things (e.g independent study, tuition reimbursement etc). Other complaints is Waitlist Anxiety, student sometime freak out if their classes are waitlisted. We are always focused on getting folks graduated on time.

Extra stuff: Signing of forms, lots of forms, e.g. registration, change of advisor forms, Field work agreement form etc